



WWAN CHIPS

Intel For 3G, WiFi Chip

Just as the news comes that companies like Motorola will ship WiFi mobile phones, Intel is gearing up to release a wireless chip that is capable

of talking to both WiFi and 3G phone networks. Intel said it will ship a joint 802.11a/g product soon, though it is not clear where this chip is to find use. The chip has been dubbed 'WWAN,' for 'Wireless Wide Area Network', and Intel might pitch it towards handset makers.

An Intel spokesman said that the picture may become clearer in two

months, hinting at an upcoming announcement surrounding, in general, the ability to roam seamlessly between WiFi hotspots and mobile phone networks. The announcement is likely to be made at the Intel Developer Forum, which opens on September 7.

Products that are already available, which could make use of the new chip, include mobile data cards for notebooks, which incorporate 3G or GSM/GPRS radios along with WiFi capabilities. Software comes into the picture, too—several firms are working on software that will allow the user to move seamlessly from one type of network to another.

Intel is working on that part, too.

TECH FOCUS ON PEOPLE, BENQ TELLS DIGIT

Here Comes The Chic

Technology is trying hard to be sexy. From Intel's Centrino to the Apple iPod, small, chic, a study in white, technology now attempts to connect with its audience. BenQ calls it engagement versus intrusion—generate emotional value around a product to engage the buyer.

At Taipei, where *Digit* visited BenQ's home ground, its products may be little known. But it is investing a great deal in building its brand. From LCDs to keyboards. AUO is the third largest manufacturer of LCD displays and BenQ has a meaty 14 per cent stake in the company. This gives them an edge in an area which is both capital and technology intensive. Indeed,



LCD TVs, monitors and large-screen smartphones such as the P30 and the P50 are harbingers of the OLED products that will soon follow (see "W5H" alongside).

Jerry Wang, Executive Vice-President and Chief Marketing Officer, isn't too keen though about Tablet PCs. "Embracing a new product category is too dangerous," he told *Digit*.

Slim 17-inch LCD monitors, widescreen Joybooks, Flash-based Joybee MP3 players, digital cameras with touch sensitive LCD and friendly UI, projectors, LCD TVs, scanners, keyboards, funky optical media—what's common to all this? Fashion and lifestyle, not technology. The colours, the organic shapes, all speak the same mantra. There's only one focus all along—people. It explains why BenQ has more software engineers than for hardware. The interface is a more important issue than most others.

Ease of use is paramount. The iPod, the Treo 600, the



TiVo stand out for user-friendliness. Peter Chen, Vice President and General Manager, Digital Media, said that Windows Longhorn was "getting even more complicated."

Chen informed that every home in Taiwan has an Ethernet connection, and that the digital home is not all that far-fetched. He said: "We are not talking about connecting fridges and microwaves. We are talking about connecting storage devices, something more real." Many IT companies are going for convergence today. But Chen's words will keep ringing for long—"Who can make it first and easier to use is the consideration. We hope to be the first." First and sexy, don't forget the sexy. ☐

(Senior Writer Ahmed Shaikh visited BenQ's headquarters on invitation. This report is meant only for information. Digit does not endorse BenQ's products listed in the story)

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Organic Light Emitting Diode

What is an OLED?

An Organic Light Emitting Diode is an organic molecule (carbon, as opposed to silicon-based) that emits light when teased with electricity. This simple concept requires one to find the right molecule to get the right colour, and you are all set for dazzling displays. Displays made with OLEDs save both on thickness and power.

Who invented OLEDs?

Kodak researcher Ching Tang, a Hong Kong-born chemist working in Rochester, New York, noticed a blue glow emanating from one of the organic solar cells he was working on.

How did he develop OLEDs?

Tang investigated the above phenomenon and published a paper on the results in 1987, concluding that organic materials were efficient converters of electricity, were great to show moving images and needed a low voltage to glow.

Why do we need OLED displays?

OLEDs are thin. They can be sprayed or printed on to very thin substrates; they neither need high-voltages to be driven nor additional power to backlight them. They also have a higher contrast and look equally bright from all angles.

Where can I find OLED displays?

Right now, as screens on small devices. Typically, an external screen of a cell phone is likely to be OLED-based, if at all.

When can I find OLED displays everywhere?

2005 is going to be the magical year for OLEDs. Expect them to proliferate from small devices such as cameras, cell phones to laptops and monitors, etc.